Module 4 · Workbook answers

Effortless Worship

Video: 26 min **Answer sheet**

The first three modules built presence with Allah inside the salah. This module takes it into the whole of life: with the right purpose and the right intention, your work, family, sleep and leisure all become worship, and the mountain diagram shows you the whole journey of tazkiyah (purifying the soul) in one picture.

Answer sheet: the answers are in red. The reflection questions are personal, so your own answers will be in your own words and from your own life. These model answers show what the session teaches, to guide and check your thinking.

Key teachings

1. **Revision: presence is for all the time**

   Huḍūr (presence with Allah) is not only for the salah; it is for the shopping, the cooking and the commute too. If you are short of money at the till, you talk to Allah about it. Module 1 gave the three keys from Surah Ta-Ha 20:46: Allah is with me, Allah sees me, Allah hears me. Module 2 added visualisation, from the hadith on ihsan (excellence in worship): worship Allah as if you see Him. Module 3 added communication, najwa (silent, intimate conversation) with Allah: bringing Him your sins, blessings, needs, problems and decisions, then sending them all up to Him so the burden lifts. None of this needs complicated learning; it is much simpler than we make it.

2. **We were created to worship, so worship must fill the day**

   Allah says He created jinn and mankind only to worship Him (51:56). When we hear "worship" we think of salah, Hajj, Qur'an, dhikr (remembrance), charity and fasting, and all of that is correct. But a busy dad working nine to five or running a business, or a busy mum balancing work, the home and raising children, barely manages a little of it each day. Look at how a lifetime is actually spent: sleep, education, early childhood, worry, scrolling, and the time that feels like "worship" is tiny. Yet the ayah covers the whole of life. So the question is how to make work, family time, sleep and even leisure into worship, so that we are with Allah around the clock, in both the deen and the dunya (this world).

3. **Two keys: purpose and intention**

   This links back to the first course. Allah existed with His attributes, He created the world of spirits, and we are on earth to reflect those attributes. You need to know that purpose now, not wait for the grave or the Day of Judgement. The second key is intention (niyyah). When your mindset connects to the Divine, that light reflects onto whatever you are doing and turns it from something dull and lifeless into the light of worship. Work, family, sleep and leisure all connect to Allah through the right intention.

4 **The young man and the dinar: everyday life as worship**

Some Companions saw a strong young man and wished his strength were being used in the cause of Allah. The Prophet ﷺ replied that if he had gone out striving for his young children, his elderly parents, or to keep himself chaste, he was in the way of Allah; only if he went out to boast and show off was he in the way of Shaytan. Likewise, in Sahih Muslim, of the dinar spent in Allah's cause, on freeing a slave, in charity to a poor person, and on your family, the greatest in reward is the one spent on your family. So instead of complaining about the bills and the children's costs, make the intention and that spending becomes charity. With the right mindset you are not worshipping for one hour a day but for twenty-three. Rejoice: your life is already full of worship; your task is to preserve that state.

5 **The salah as your catch-up meeting with Allah**

If the whole day is worship, the salah becomes the meeting point with Allah: a catch-up meeting to review how the day is going. How are you getting on? What problems are you facing? Did something not go to plan, or did you slip into a sin? Bring all of it, using the communication practice from Module 3, while the aim of the whole day stays the same: to reflect the attributes of Allah.

6 **The mountain diagram: what you need before setting out**

The mountain diagram is a summary of the entire journey in one place. At the foot of the mountain are four conditions. 1. Belief (iman): the right belief is needed for the journey to reach its ultimate goal. 2. Rules: knowing how to pray, fast and pay zakah, and what is halal and haram, otherwise you will not know what to do. 3. A mindset of repentance (tawbah): your children learn more from seeing you turn back to Allah after a mistake, such as shouting, and saying astaghfirullah than from anything you say to them. 4. A mindset of striving (mujahadah): know from the start that it will be a struggle and a push. Then you cross the bridge, purifying your body, mind, heart and soul one by one.

7 **The objectives, the goal, and what is not the goal**

How do you know you are getting anywhere? Ask yourself four questions. Do I give preference to Allah and His commands? Do I give preference to, and love, the Sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ? Am I more compassionate towards creation? Am I more present with Allah while shopping, cooking and working? The ultimate goal is the pleasure of Allah, and it comes as a mercy, not as payment for deeds. A father, pleased that his son had memorised al-Fatihah, took him to a shop, where the boy recited it and was given sweets. The next day the boy went back alone and recited it again, but got nothing. The shopkeeper explained: the sweets came because your father was pleased with you and rewarded you, not because of the recitation itself. So keep your sincerity and stay humble. What are not objectives: a special dream, seeing the Prophet ﷺ in a dream, waking visions, feelings, or stories of miracles. If they come, alhamdulillah, but they are not the aim, and praying only when you "feel like it" means worshipping your feelings.

8 **The shortcut: spreading the message**

The hack that speeds up the whole journey is sharing it. Allah tells the believers to protect themselves and their families from the Fire (66:6), so start with your family, then your community. Asking the Prophet ﷺ for help is being a customer; sharing his concern, which was to save all of humanity, makes you a shareholder, and a shareholder is closer. People sitting at "base camp" in heedlessness need thirst builders, such as a well-chosen story. For example, the sun and the wind competed to make a man take off his coat: the harder the wind blew, the tighter he held it, but when the sun shone warmly he took it off. Shouting often makes things worse; gentleness is heard. You can even ask an AI tool for a story suited to a child's age. At the start your focus is yourself, and da'wah (inviting to Allah) is not for everyone straight away; when you are ready, discuss it with your mentor.

From the Qur'an and the Sunnah

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ ٱلْجِنَّ وَٱلْإِنسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me.

Surah adh-Dhariyat 51:56

قَالَ لَا تَخَافَآ ۖ إِنَّنِى مَعَكُمَآ أَسْمَعُ وَأَرَىٰ

[Allāh] said, "Fear not. Indeed, I am with you both; I hear and I see."

Surah Ta-Ha 20:46

Some Companions saw a strong, energetic young man and said, "O Messenger of Allah, if only this were in the cause of Allah!" He ﷺ said: "If he has gone out striving for his young children, he is in the cause of Allah. If he has gone out striving for his elderly parents, he is in the cause of Allah. If he has gone out striving to keep himself chaste, he is in the cause of Allah. But if he has gone out to show off and boast, he is in the cause of Shaytan."

al-Tabarani, al-Mu'jam al-Kabir

A dinar you spend in the cause of Allah, a dinar you spend to free a slave, a dinar you give in charity to a poor person, and a dinar you spend on your family: the greatest of them in reward is the one you spend on your family.

Sahih Muslim

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا۟ قُوٓا۟ أَنفُسَكُمْ وَأَهْلِيكُمْ نَارًا وَقُودُهَا ٱلنَّاسُ وَٱلْحِجَارَةُ

O you who have believed, protect yourselves and your families from a Fire whose fuel is people and stones...

Surah at-Tahrim 66:6

Practical exercises

Turn your day into worship

1. List the main blocks of your day: work, family, chores, sleep, leisure.
2. For each one, write an intention that connects it to Allah, e.g. "I work to provide for my family for the sake of Allah."
3. Make that intention in your heart as each part of the day begins.
4. When you pay a bill or spend on your family, remind yourself that this is charity.
5. In the evening, write how it felt to see your ordinary day as worship.

The salah catch-up meeting

1. Before one prayer today, pause and ask: how is my day going with Allah?
2. Come into presence with the three keys: Allah is with me, sees me and hears me.
3. In your heart, bring Him the day so far: what went well, what went wrong, any sin, any problem.
4. Leave it with Him, and set your intention for the rest of the day.
5. Afterwards, write what you brought and what changed.

Find yourself on the mountain

1. Check the four conditions at the foot of the mountain: belief, rules, repentance and striving. Which is weakest for you?
2. Rate yourself on the four objectives: preference for Allah's commands, love of the Sunnah, compassion for creation, presence with Allah.
3. Pick one small step to strengthen your weakest area this week.
4. Write it down, and remind yourself that the goal is Allah's pleasure, reached through His mercy, with sincerity and humility.

7-day practice: effortless worship

Tick each day you practise.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Made an intention for work, family and sleep							
Used a prayer as a catch-up meeting with Allah							
Remembered Allah during an everyday task							
Shared something good with my family							

Reflection questions and answers

1. Before this module, which parts of your day did you think of as worship, and which did you not?

> Most of us think of worship as salah, Hajj, Qur'an, dhikr (remembrance), charity and fasting, and all of that is correct. But Allah says He created us only to worship Him (51:56), and that ayah covers the whole of life: work, family time, sleep and even leisure. For example: "I only counted my five prayers and a little Qur'an as worship. My job, the school run and the cooking felt like time away from Allah."

2. Which ordinary part of your day (work, family, sleep, leisure) is hardest to see as worship? What intention could change that?

> This module gives two keys: knowing your purpose, and making the right intention (niyyah). When your mindset connects to Allah, that light turns something dull and lifeless into worship, just as the young man in the hadith was in the cause of Allah simply by working for his children or his elderly parents. For example: "Work feels like a grind, but if I leave each morning intending to provide for my family for the sake of Allah, those hours become worship."

3. How does the hadith of the dinar change the way you feel about what you spend on your family?

> In Sahih Muslim, four dinars are mentioned: one spent in Allah's cause, one to free a slave, one in charity to a poor person and one on your family. The greatest in reward is the one spent on your family. So bills and the children's costs, spent with the right intention, become charity rather than something to complain about. For example: "I used to sigh at the shopping bill; now I can make the intention and see it as some of my most rewarded spending."

4. Of the four conditions at the foot of the mountain, which needs the most work for you, and why?

> The four conditions are belief (iman), knowing the rules (how to pray, fast and pay zakah, and what is halal and haram), a mindset of repentance (tawbah) and a mindset of striving (mujahadah). A good answer names the weakest honestly and says why. For example: "Repentance needs the most work. When I shout at the children I just move on, yet they would learn more from seeing me say astaghfirullah and turn back to Allah than from anything I tell them."

5. Have you ever measured your closeness to Allah by dreams, feelings or experiences? What do the four objectives ask of you instead?

> The session is clear that special dreams, seeing the Prophet ﷺ in a dream, waking visions, feelings and stories of miracles are not the goal; if they come, alhamdulillah, but praying only when you "feel like it" means worshipping your feelings. Instead, the four objectives ask: Do I give preference to Allah and His commands? Do I love and prefer the Sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ? Am I more compassionate towards creation? Am I more present with Allah while shopping, cooking and working?

6. Who in your family could you share this journey with, and what story or example might open their heart?

> Allah tells the believers to protect themselves and their families from the Fire (66:6), so sharing starts at home. Sharing the Prophet's ﷺ concern for all of humanity makes you a shareholder, not just a customer, and gentleness is heard where shouting is not, as the story of the sun and the wind shows. For example: "I could tell my son the story of the sun and the wind at dinner, then talk together about how gentleness wins hearts."

My action plan

- [ ] I will make an intention for Allah's sake at the start of work, family time and sleep.
- [ ] I will treat my bills and family spending as charity, with the right intention, instead of complaining.
- [ ] I will use at least one prayer each day as a catch-up meeting with Allah.
- [ ] I will check myself against the four objectives, not against dreams or feelings.

- [ ] I will let my family see me turn to Allah in repentance when I make a mistake.
- [ ] I will share one lesson from this course with my family this week, gently and with a story.